GG-S-1554
April 2, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GG-T-406a
May 19, 1947

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

STAMP, TIME (ELECTRIC CORRESPONDENCE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers 115 or 230 volt A.C., 50 or 60 Hertz electrically-operated time stamps for use on correspondence (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Time stamps furnished under this specification shall be of the following class, styles and models, as specified (see 6.1):

Class A - Synchonous Motor Drive.

Style 1 - Adjustable For Light, Medium and Heavy Imprint or Light and Heavy Imprint.
Style 2 - Nonadjustable Imprint.

Model a - Hand trip.
Model b - Paper trip automatic.
Model c - Remote trip.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or requests for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

J-C-175 Cable Assembly, Power, Electrical (3 Wire Grounding Type, For Use on 125 Volt Equipment)
DDD-R-271 - Ribbons, Computing And Recording Machine.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Edged And Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which include cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for a sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:54
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-169 - Extreme Temperature Cycle.
MIL-STD-170 - Moisture Resistance Test cycle for Ground Signal Equipment.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal shall apply:

Underwriters' Laboratories (UL), Inc. Standard:

No. 863 - Time-Indicating and Recording Appliances.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, Illinois 60611; 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062; 1285 Walt Whitman Road, Melville, Long Island, NY 11746; or 1655 Scott Boulevard, Santa Clara, CA 95050.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and Casualty Hazards.

3.1.1 Each contractor shall submit to the contracting agency proof that each Time Stamp he proposes to supply under this specification conforms to the requirements of UL 863 Time-Indicating and Recording appliances. The listing mark of the Underwriters' Laboratories, affixed to each fixture may be accepted as evidence that the product conforms to this requirement. Compliance with the above preliminary requirements in regard to fire, safety and casualty hazards does not absolve the contractor from complete compliance with the other requirements of this specification in order to secure acceptance of his material or equipment."

3.1.2 In lieu of the label of listing with re-examination, the contractor may submit independent proof, satisfactory to the contracting agency, that his equipment conforms to the published standards, including methods of tests of UL 863.

3.2 General design. Each time stamp shall consist essentially of an imprint mechanism and a timing mechanism contained in a suitable housing complete with cable assembly.

3.3 Materials. Materials used in the time stamps furnished under this specification shall be as specified herein, and where material is not specified, a material shall be used which will meet the performance requirements of this specification.

3.3.1 Metal. Metals used shall be either corrosion resistant or suitably treated to resist corrosion in atmospheric conditions to which the time stamp will be subjected when in storage or during use.

3.3.2 Dissimilar metals. Dissimilar metals, especially brass, copper or steel in contact with magnesium, aluminum or other alloys, shall be avoided wherever practicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.1 Position of imprint. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the imprint shall be produced on the upperside of the paper when the paper is in place for stamping.

4.3.2 Time-line imprint. The imprint shall consist of; Date, Month, Year, and 0000 to 2359 hours inclusive. When specified (see 6.1), the dateline shall include a "Z" to indicate Greenwich zero longitude time. When specified (see 6.1), the imprint of hour, minute, AM and PM shall be furnished. The sequence of the time line imprint shall be the manufacturer's standard arrangement. The imprint shall be on one line not exceed 2 inches in length and the and the characters shall be 0.156 inch high ± 0.034 inch.

3.4.3 Imprint mechanism. The imprint mechanism shall consist of engraved character wheels of brass, steel, bronze or diecast alloy. The wheels shall be clean cut and of sufficient diameter to prevent ghosts from adjacent characters either above or below the imprinted character. The imprint shall be sharp, clear and of a size to be legible at a normal reading distance.

3.4.3.1 Character wheels. The day of month, hour, minute, and meridian character wheels shall be an integrated train of wheels, so designed to be advanced in the proper sequence by one minute intervals. The character wheels shall be readily replaceable.

3.4.3.2 Month and Year wheels. The month and year wheels shall be hand set. The year wheel shall be numbered with a consecutive series of not less than 10 years beginning with the year specified in the invitation for bid (see 6.1).

3.4.3.3 Resetting. Design of the wheel shall permit convenient manual resetting of the character wheels and at the same time prevent tampering with the setting by unauthorized persons. If multiple keyholes are used, each hole shall be permanently marked to indicate the character wheels to which it applies with direction indicated to advance the wheel forward. The design shall be such that all wheels may be set without the necessity of disconnecting the operating current.

3.4.4 Fixed imprint. Each time stamp shall have space provided for the imprint of additional text both above and below the time line imprint. The space provided shall not be less than 0.450 inch by 1.750 inch in area. The Fixed imprint test shall be impressed by the use of plates and/or slugs. The text of the fixed imprint shall be as specified in the invitation for bid (see 6.1).

3.4.4.1 Plates. Imprint plates shall be removable type, firmly secured in place.

3.4.4.2 Slugs. The design of the slugs and slugholders shall permit ease of replacement. The slug(s) shall be the size specified in the invitation for bid (see 6.1).

3.5 Ribbon .

3.5.1 Material. Imprint shall be made through inked ribbons conforming to the requirements of DDD-R-271. The color of the inked ribbons shall be purple unless otherwise specified (see 6.1).

3.5.2 Operation and design. The ribbon shall be automatically advanced each time an imprint is made. When either end of travel is reached, the direction of ribbon travel shall be automatically reversed. The ribbon shall be readily replaceable without rewinding from its spool or disconnecting the current.

3.6 Dial and hands. When specified in the invitation for bid (see 6.1), a time-indicating dial and hands with cover shall be furnished as an integral part of the time stamp. If not specified, the color and marking of the dial and hands is optional with the manufacturer.

3.7 Housing. The housing shall be of such material and construction to withstand normal handling and operation in service, and to furnish adequate support and protection for the mechanism. Bright trim, where used, shall be of a non-corrosive material. The base shall have a suitable protective means, so as not to mar polished surfaces upon which the time stamp might be placed.

3.8 Marking. Each time stamp shall be permanently marked with the name or registered trade-mark of the manufacturer and the electrical rating data including voltage, amperage, and the number of Hertz.

3.9 Clock Mechanism. The clock mechanism shall be electrically operated with an accuracy of ± 5 seconds every 24 hours. (see 4.4.5).

3.10 Styles and models.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.10.1 Style 1 - Adjustable imprint. The mechanism shall be adjustable so that the imprint force may be varied to suit the quantity of the text which may be set up in the stamp. The striking force shall be independent of the force applied to the initiating mechanism. Contacts controlling the striking mechanism circuit shall be tungsten, silver, or suitable alloys thereof, and shall be easily replaceable.

3.10.1.1 Model a - hand trip. The striking mechanism of the "model a" time stamp shall be operated by means of a trigger, a push bar, or a plate so located as to be readily tripped by the operator with the same hand used to insert the paper.

3.10.1.2 Model b - paper trip. The design of the "model b" time stamp shall be such as to initiate the action of the striking mechanism automatically when paper is inserted a predetermined distance for proper reception of the imprint. The trip mechanism shall be so designed that it may be adjusted to imprint at a preselected distance from the edge of the paper to the imprint.

3.10.1.3 Model c - Remote trip. The "model c" time stamps shall be equipped with a built-in relay for remote control operation in lieu of the hand trip or perper trip. The voltage and frequency, if a.c., of the relay circuit shall be as specified in the invitation for bid (see 6.1). It may differ from that of the imprint striking mechanism circuit.

3.11 Style II - Non-adjustable imprint. The imprint force shall be strong enough to make a complete, clear, legible copy through both an orginial and one carbon copy of material with the carbon paper still in place. The imprint shall include text both above and below the time line imprint. (see 4.4.1)

3.12 Cable assembly. Each time stamp shall be furnished with a cable assembly in accordance with J-C-175, Class 5, grade B and a length of 6 feet. The color of the cable jacket shall be black or gray. The cable shall be reinforced with insulating rubber grommet or sleeve where is passes through the timer housing, and shall be securely clamped or anchored to the timer housing, by insulating type clamps in a manner to prevent mechanical strain on the conductor connection.

3.13 Temperature rise. The temperature rise of any electrical part, except breaker points, of any time stamp shall not exceed 40° C. (72° F.) above ambient air when tested as described in 4.4.2.

3.14 Temperature. When tested in accordance with 4.4.3, the performance shall be as follows: The operating ambient temperature shall be in the range of + 40° F. to + 105° F. The exposures at the high temperature extreme shall not exceed 4 hours, and at the low temperature not to exceed 72 hours, at any one time. Nonoperating ambient temperature shall be in the range of - 40° F. to + 150° F. The exposure at the high temperature extreme shall not exceed 4 hours, and at the low temperature not to exceed 24 hours, at any one time.

3.15 Relative humidity. When specified (see 6.1). The time stamp shall meet all operating requirements of this specification when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.

3.16 Workmanship. All time stamps furnished under this specification shall be first-grade commercial products and shall be free from mechanical and electrical defects.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Inspection lot. All time stamps of the same class, style and model presented for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of acceptance inpsection.

4.3 Inspection. Each sample shall be inspected for compliance with the requirements of this specification and in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Each sample shall be given a general inspection for workmanship, material, general design, assembly design where applicable, insulation operation of timing mechanism, dimension where applicable, finish, color, and marking with lot acceptance based on an Inspection Level of Level II and an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Tests. The sample for tests shall be in accordance with inspection Level S-3 of MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective. The samples shall be tested to determine conformance to this specification. Where requirements specified herein duplicates those of the U.L Standard, the applicable test need not be performed and the label or listing mark of U.L will be accepted as evidence of meeting thise requirements.

4.4.1 The imprint mechanism shall be operated at six different settings with a single sheet of material and the impression examined for compliance with 3.4.3. If a Style II time stamp is being tested, the imprint mechanism shall be operated at six different settings by an original and one carbon copy with the carbon paper still in place. The impressions on both sheets shall be examined for compliance with 3.4.3 and 3.11.

4.4.2 Temperature Rise. Each sample shall be operated at a rate of 60 strikes per minute, continuously for 2 hours during which time the temperature rise of the electrical parts shall be measured to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.13. Temperature may be obtained by a thermocouple or glass bulb thermometer packed against the parts tested. The instrument used to determine the rise in temperature shall be accurate to $\pm$ 5°F.

4.4.3 Temperature Test. The equipment shall be subjected to the temperature cycles specified in 3.14, and as shown in MIL-STD-169 except in the operation cycle the steps shall be as follow: 1, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9, and 10.

4.4.4 Moisture-resistance test for equipment. The time stamp shall be set-up in normal operating position and tested to determine compliance with 4.4.5.1 and 4.4.5.2.

4.4.4.1 Test as indicated on MIL-STD-170.

(a) Dry at 130° F for 4 hours.
(b) Condition at 86° F for 6 hours
(c) Cool at 68° F for 2 hours
(d) Subject to three continuous 24 hour temperature changing cycles, (a), (b) and (c) above. Notes 1,2,3, and 4 on Mil-Std-170 shall apply except the temperature specified in (a) above.
(e) After cycling has been completed, condition the equipment for 24 hours at 75° $\pm$ 5° F and 40 to 60 percent relative humidity. No repair or replacement of parts shall be made. The equipment shall pass all applicable operating tests in paragraph 4.4.

4.4.5 Accuracy. In lieu of testing for accuracy, a certificate of compliance from the clock manufacturer will be acceptable for the requirements stated in 3.9.

4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

TABLE I. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents	Number of packages per shipping container is more or or less than required.
	Net weight exceed requirements of PPP-B-636.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Each stamp shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic, PPP-B-665 or to PPP-B-676. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.2 Level B. Each stamp shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic, PPP-B-665 or to PPP-B-676. Each box shall be closed to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 Level C. Each stamp shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturers standard practice, providing that this will insure protection for the stamp during shipment and provides for safe delivery to its destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Stamps packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities as specified in the contract or order in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Close, waterproof seal and strap the containers in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636. The weight of each shipping container shall be within the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Stamps packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities as specified in the contract or order in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure and sealing of the containers shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636. The weight of each shipping container shall be within the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Stamps packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules as applicable.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. Notes.

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, symbol, and date of specification
(b) Voltage and hertz required (see 1.1)
(c) Type, class and style desired (see 1.2)
(d) Position of imprint if other than specified (see 3.4.1)
(e) Imprint of Hours, Minutes, AM, and PM, when required (see 3.4.2)
(f) Date line to include "Z", when required (see 3.4.2)
(g) Year wheel, starting year (see 3.4.3.2)
(h) Test of fixed imprint (see 3.4.4)
(i) Size of slug or slugs desired (see 3.4.4.2)
(j) Color of Imprint, if other than specified (see 3.5.1)
(k) Time-indicating dial and hands, when required (see 3.6)
(l) Humidity Test when specified (see 3.15)
(m) Voltage and Frequency, of relay circuit (see 3.10.1.3)
(n) Responsibility for inspection, if other than specified (see 4.1)
(o) Selection of the applicable level of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(p) Marking, if other than specified (see 5.3)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Review activities:

Army - MU
Air Force - 82

Preparing Activity:

GSA - FSS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-20
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.